Oral defense: the questions

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AP RESEARCH · PRESENTATION AND ORAL DEFENSE · 25 PERCENT OF YOUR SCORE

How it works. You present for no more than 15 minutes. Then a panel of three, your teacher and two other adults, asks you three questions from this list: one from each group. They may tailor the wording to your project, and may ask a fourth question to clarify an answer. These are College Board's questions, word for word, from the Course and Exam Description, page 62.

Research or inquiry process: choices made throughout the research process

1. How did your initial exploration of the scholarly conversation lead to your final research question/project goal?
2. How did your review of the methods used by scholars in the field inform your selection of a research method/process that is aligned with your research question/project goal?
3. How did the choices you made when designing or implementing your research method impact your research process?
4. How did you determine which results generated by your research method were most important in informing your new understanding?

Depth of understanding: relating student data/results to the new understanding

1. How does your new understanding address a gap in the scholarly conversation?
2. How did the limitations of your method or data influence your new understanding?
3. What are the real-world implications or consequences related to your findings?
4. How do your findings provide directions for future research in the field?

Reflection throughout the inquiry process: how the inquiry process informs growth and self-awareness as a researcher

1. Think back to the initial curiosity that sparked your inquiry. What other curiosities do you have and how has this process prepared you to explore them?
2. How did you handle the uncertainty of the research process?
3. If you could revisit your research process, what would you do differently and why?
4. What was the most important research skill you developed as a result of this process, and how might you apply it to your future endeavors?
5. How did your expert adviser facilitate your deeper understanding of the research process? (Asked only if you worked with an expert adviser.)

College Board allows no use of AI to prepare for the oral defense. You may not use it to generate possible answers. Your answers come from your own work and your own portfolio.

Oral defense: my evidence

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YOUR OWN NOTES, IN YOUR OWN WORDS · BRING YOUR PORTFOLIO

STUDENT CODE _____ PERIOD _____ DATE _____

Do not write answers to memorize. For each group, note where in your own work the evidence is, so that you can speak from it.

Group	Where the evidence is in my paper and portfolio: pages, dates, entries
Research or inquiry process the choices I made, and why	
Depth of understanding what my results mean, and their limits	
Reflection how I changed as a researcher	

One choice I would make differently, and where my portfolio shows it

The third question draws on your reflection "as evidenced in your process and reflection portfolio." Keep the portfolio current. It is your evidence.